

SPINE v2.0.4: DISPOSITION OF THE GPT ATTACK · 2026-09-13

GPT attacked spine v2.0.4 after three Fable rounds had taken it to *PROCEED WITH CHANGES* twice. GPT: *REWORK*, high confidence, six fronts each rated fatal (episode-1-spine-four-keys-v2.0-attack-chatgpt-2026-09-13.md). Findings in order of fatality with my concurrence and a provisional answer, each checked against the world facts in Parts A to G. Walked with Stephen one row at a time; the Status column records his ruling. Stephen's standard: hard evidence kills, a count of fatals does not.

The shape of this round

Fable's three rounds and GPT's one are looking at the same joints. Fable rated them serious and answerable by rows; GPT rates them fatal. On each, the question is whether a world fact or a paid choice already on the page answers it, or whether GPT has found a wall. My reading: five are answered by facts already in the spine or by one row of world; one (front 5) is a real error in the chapter 7 row that the v2.0.4 rewrite of Day 14 already fixed upstream and I failed to carry into Day 311.

The table

#	Finding	GPT	Concur?	Provisional answer	Status
1	The pool (GPT's driver). "Told only you four" is not "only four could know": someone could have watched Violet or one of the four at the pot, or followed them. R20 covers overhearing, not observation. Four competent adults discard the alternative Violet's own instruction names.	Fatal	Partly. The room's inference was always frightened rather than proven, and the jeopardy ruling indicts it. But the observation route can be closed by a fact about the yard, and it should be.	The second pot is inside the yard, under the step by the yard door: a high wall on the lane side and a solid gate that latches from inside. The pot cannot be seen from the lane, from N°14 or from anywhere but inside her yard or her house. So "watched" means someone already in her yard or house, which is the same pool. "Followed one of the four" is R20: three tellings indoors, alone, and one at a car door with nobody within a sentence. On Day 15 Liam, who fitted the gate, says so, and the room writes it down: nobody could have seen the pot who wasn't already inside. The inference is then honest, and still wrong about who, which is the story.	Open
2	Violet makes the evidence uniquely vulnerable and tells Brad the release mechanism. No independent record of the panel; one copy; the solicitor not told; Brad told.	Fatal	Partly. Two things are already in the world: the store is beyond the pool's control until she dies (only keys at Civic Row), and the independent record of the panel exists in four people who saw it and can describe it, which is exactly Ally's source in chapter 9. What GPT names is her refusal, which is foundation 3 and is paid three times on the page.	Add the sentence that makes it explicit: she believes the four people she showed it to are its record, and they are; the store is beyond anyone's reach while she lives; telling Brad tells him nothing he would not learn with the other three on the day she dies, and to keep it from him alone is to name him, which she will not do. That is the third refusal, already written at A1 –19; this row states what it costs and why it is not incompetence but the premise.	Open

#	Finding	GPT	Concur?	Provisional answer	Status
3	Brad keeps the panel on Day 14 and burns it on Day 325 , so possession is not a compulsion, and the risk on Day 14 was already existential.	Fatal	No. The risk is not the same on the two days, and the world says why.	On Day 14 nobody alive can connect the panel to him: the four never saw it, the trade saw it in Violet's hands as hers, and it hangs 400 miles away under a monogram that is his initials there (D1 constraint 6: innocuous in a stranger's house). On Day 325 Ally describes it on air, crack and mark, to a listener base that includes his landlady (R13: the download in that town from Day 283). The risk becomes specific to a room, and he acts inside the hour. Keeping it is his want (D1 constraint 5, the thing Stephen's premise is built on); burning it is the moment the want costs more than he will pay. Both are the same man. Written already in D1 and C2 Week 47; one sentence in C2 Week 3 to say the Day 14 risk was nil.	Open
4	Margo on Day 8 should tell the sister the missing book recorded a loan to Brad being called in, with her dated note. Privacy is not a reason; the estate decides enforceability.	Fatal	Partly. GPT is right that "gift" is the wrong word; the spine says loan. What holds is the professional norm, and it is not yet on the page.	On Day 8 there is no administrator. Letters of administration are granted about Day 40; until then the sister is next of kin with the house keys and no authority over Violet's private affairs, and a professional gives a dead client's private information to the personal representative once appointed, not to a relative in a kitchen. Margo tells the sister what the sister is entitled to on Day 8 (the business books; a private book is missing) and tells the estate's accountant everything on Day 45, the first day anyone with authority asks. Her Day 8 position is re-worded from "gift" to "a private loan Violet refused to paper, told in confidence, and nobody yet appointed to receive it". The cost stays paid.	Open
5	Chapter 7 airs no contradiction: "just opened" is consistent with collecting at seven and opening later.	Fatal to the turn	Yes, against the Day 311 row as written. My error: v2.0.4 changed Day 14 so that Brad's line is a claim about arrival ("same, just now" to Liam's "mine only came tonight"), and I left the old "only just opened his" in the chapter 7 row.	Day 311 re-worded to what Day 14 now says: Liam's account on the record, that he said his had only come tonight and Brad said same; the counter clerk that the overnight sort is in the boxes before seven; both survivors that Brad cleared his box at seven every morning. Ally's claim: his post was in his box at seven and he said it came that evening. That is a claim about arrival, and it is false, and Ally can source every part of it.	Open
6	Violet should have retained the dosed tobacco as evidence; a retained sample later is new evidence of an act (R19).	Fatal	Partly. She binned it, which is canon (A1 -37; her true letter: I've thrown the tobacco out). The act GPT names is competent and she does not take it, so the row must say why and pay it.	Her book: I threw it out. If I'd kept it I'd have had to do something with it. The same refusal as the key and the sum: she would rather it was her own carelessness, and a kept sample is a decision to find out. Paid at the same price. And the world: the police on Day 1 know of no tin; nothing under the stairs is abnormal to look at; the tobacco is in a bin emptied on Day -34. Row in A1 -37 and C1 -6.	Open

Provisional verdict, before the walk

GPT's six fatals are Fable's serious rows seen through a stricter lens on competence. Four are answered by facts already in the spine plus one sentence each (the yard's geometry; the trade as the panel's record; the Day 14 versus Day 325 risk; the personal representative norm). One is Violet's refusal, extended a fourth time to

the tobacco, and paid. One (front 5) is a genuine error in my chapter 7 row, already fixed upstream on Day 14 and now to be carried down. None is a wall. If Stephen accepts the six, the spine goes to v2.0.5 and, since both adversaries have now had it and neither broke the device, v8.1 is superseded on his ruling.